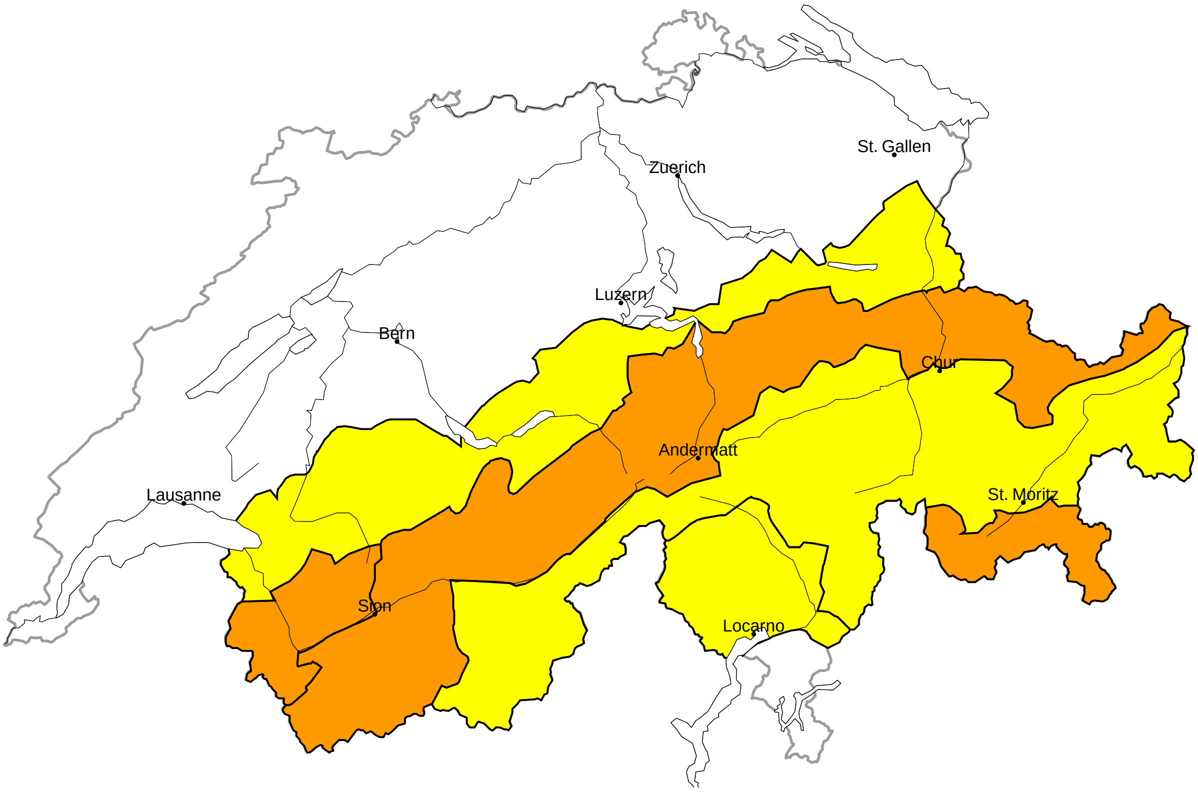
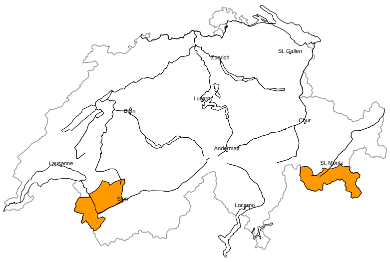
Avalanche bulletin through Friday, 15. May 2026

Avalanche danger

updated on 14.5.2026, 17:00

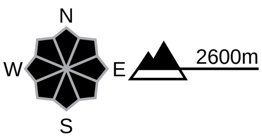


region A | Considerable (3-)



New snow, Persistent weak layers

Avalanche prone locations

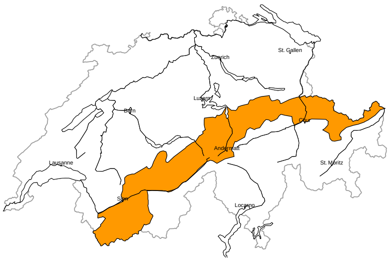


Danger description

The new snow and wind slabs of the last few days are in some cases prone to triggering. The wind slabs will be covered with new snow and therefore barely recognisable. Dry avalanches can additionally be released in the old snowpack in particular on very steep north and east facing slopes. Avalanches can reach large size in isolated cases. Ski touring calls for defensive route selection.
The Avalanche Warning Service currently has only a small amount of information that has been collected in the field, so that the avalanche danger should be investigated especially thoroughly in the relevant locality.

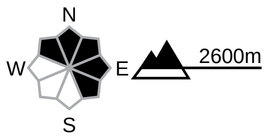
Danger levels 1 low 2 moderate 3 considerable 4 high 5 very high

region B — Considerable (3-)



Wind slab, Persistent weak layers

Avalanche prone locations



Danger description

The wind slabs of the last few days are in some cases prone to triggering. They will be covered with new snow and therefore barely recognisable. Dry avalanches can additionally be released in the old snowpack in particular on very steep north and east facing slopes. Avalanches can reach large size in isolated cases. Ski touring calls for defensive route selection.
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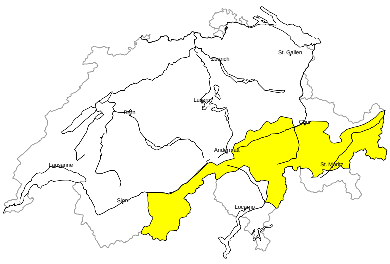
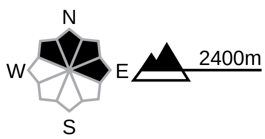
region C — Moderate (2+)



Wind slab, Persistent weak layers

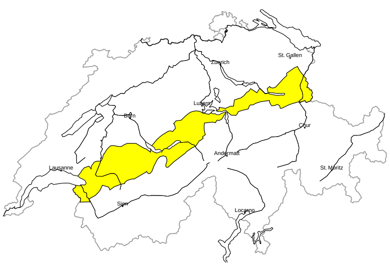
Avalanche prone locations



Danger description

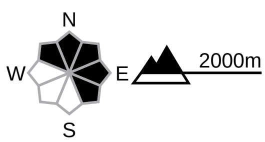
The wind slabs of the last few days are in some cases prone to triggering. They will be covered with new snow and therefore barely recognisable. Additionally avalanches can also be released in near-surface layers and reach medium size. These avalanche prone locations are rather rare but are barely recognisable. Careful route selection is recommended.
The Avalanche Warning Service currently has only a small amount of information that has been collected in the field, so that the avalanche danger should be investigated especially thoroughly in the relevant locality.

region D — Moderate (2=)



Wind slab

Avalanche prone locations



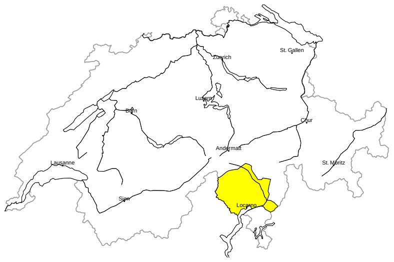
Danger description

As a consequence of new snow and a sometimes strong westerly wind, avalanche prone wind slabs formed on Ascension Day in particular in gullies and bowls and behind abrupt changes in the terrain. These will be covered with new snow and therefore barely recognisable. Persons can release avalanches in some places. These can reach medium size. Careful route selection is recommended.
The Avalanche Warning Service currently has only a small amount of information that has been collected in the field, so that the avalanche danger should be investigated especially thoroughly in the relevant locality.

Danger levels 1 low | 2 moderate | 3 considerable | 4 high | 5 very high

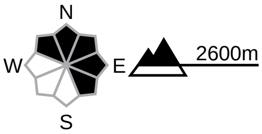
region E

Moderate (2=)



Wind slab

Avalanche prone locations



Danger description

Somewhat older wind slabs are to be found in particular at the base of rock walls and behind abrupt changes in the terrain. These are rather small but in some cases prone to triggering. They are to be evaluated with care and prudence in very steep terrain. Apart from the danger of being buried, restraint should be exercised as well in view of the danger of avalanches sweeping people along and giving rise to falls.
The Avalanche Warning Service currently has only a small amount of information that has been collected in the field, so that the avalanche danger should be investigated especially thoroughly in the relevant locality.

Snowpack and weather

updated on 14.5.2026, 17:00

Snowpack

New and drifted snow are overlaid on an old snowpack, the top section of which contains coarse-grained weak layers, primarily on north- and east-facing slopes at high altitudes.

Weather review for Ascension Day

Conditions were mostly very cloudy. Snow fell at times above approximately 1500 m. There were brief sunny spells in between, with longer sunny periods in Valais.

Fresh snow
Up until Ascension Day afternoon, the following amounts of snow fell above approximately 2000 m:

- Extreme west of Lower Valais, Val Bregaglia to Bernina region: 15 to 30 cm
- Elsewhere a widespread 5 to 15 cm, less in the Upper Valais and Ticino

Temperature
At midday at 2000 m, between -2 °C in the north and +2 °C in the south

Wind
Moderate, sometimes strong from the west along the Prealps

Weather forecast to Friday

It will be mostly cloudy, with snow falling above approximately 1300 m.

Fresh snow
From Ascension Day to Friday afternoon, the following amounts of snow will fall above approximately 1800 m:

- Northern flank of the Alps, Lower Valais and Grisons: 5 to 15 cm
- Upper Valais and Ticino: less

Temperature
At midday at 2000 m, around -2 °C

Wind
Mainly light

Outlook

Saturday
In the north, it will be very cloudy, with snow falling above approximately 1300 m. The heaviest snowfall will occur along the northern Alpine ridge from the Bernese Oberland to the Säntis, with approximately 20 cm expected.
In the south it will be sunny with northerly winds.
There will be a widespread increase in avalanche risk. In Upper Valais and Ticino, it will not change significantly.

Sunday
After a mostly clear night, it will be sunny. Winds will be light. The zero-degree level will rise to 2100 m in the north and 2500 m in the south.
The danger of dry avalanches will decrease. As a consequence of solar radiation, near-surface wet avalanches are to be expected as the day progresses.